Returns & refunds

POLICY REF. ACME-SUPPORT-01

The 30-day return window

Customers can request a return within 30 calendar days of delivery. The order must be a direct purchase from the fictional Acme store. Ask for the order number and the email address used at checkout. A receipt screenshot is optional when the order can already be located in the support system. Start the return window on the delivery date, not the date the customer opened the parcel.

What qualifies

Unused products in their original packaging qualify for a standard refund. Opened products can qualify when the customer reports a manufacturing defect. Gift cards, personalized items, and downloadable products do not qualify for a change-of-mind refund. A damaged shipment follows the replacement process on page 2. Support agents must document any exception and record the approving team lead before promising a refund.

Timing and payment

Approved refunds are issued to the original payment method within five business days after the returned item is received and inspected. The receiving bank may take an additional three to seven business days to display the credit. Original expedited shipping charges are not refunded for change-of-mind returns. Acme pays return shipping when it confirms a product defect or a packing error.

A clear customer response

Tell the customer the next required action, the return address supplied by the support system, and the expected refund timeline. Do not ask for a full card number or payment password. If the customer has not received the credit after twelve business days, escalate the case with the return tracking number, inspection date, and refund reference.

Shipping & replacements

POLICY REF. ACME-SUPPORT-02

Delivery estimates

Standard shipping usually arrives within four to seven business days after dispatch. Express shipping usually arrives within two business days after dispatch. These estimates exclude weekends and local public holidays. Orders placed before noon are normally prepared on the same business day, although personalization can add two preparation days. The confirmation email states the selected service and the dispatch tracking link.

A parcel that has not arrived

Ask the customer to check the tracking page, delivery address, and any safe-place delivery note. If tracking says delivered, allow one business day for a carrier scan correction and ask the customer to check with their building reception. If the parcel remains missing, open a carrier investigation. Give the customer the investigation reference and a next update within two business days.

Damage or the wrong item

Customers should report shipping damage or an incorrect item within seven calendar days of delivery. Request a photo of the affected item and the outer packaging only when it helps confirm the issue. Never require an image containing personal identification. Once verified, offer a replacement at no additional charge or a refund through the process on page 1. Do not promise inventory that has not been checked.

Closing the replacement case

A replacement is sent using the original shipping service unless a team lead approves an upgrade. Share the new tracking number as soon as it becomes available. If the item is out of stock, offer a refund or let the customer choose to wait for the documented restock date. Record the chosen remedy and close the case only after the customer receives confirmation.

Accounts & escalation

POLICY REF. ACME-SUPPORT-03

Safe account recovery

Customers reset their password using the Forgot password link on the fictional Acme sign-in page. A reset link expires after 30 minutes and can be used once. If a customer cannot find the message, ask them to check the spam folder and confirm the spelling of their address. Support must never ask for the existing password, a complete payment card number, or an authentication code.

Response commitments

The standard support inbox is staffed Monday through Friday from 09:00 to 17:00 in the customer account time zone. The target first response is one business day. A first response acknowledges the problem and names the next action; it does not guarantee resolution. If more investigation is needed, provide a specific update time and keep that commitment even when there is no final answer.

When to escalate

Escalate suspected unauthorized access immediately to the security response queue. Escalate repeated delivery failures, disputed refund decisions, and requests outside the documented policy to a support team lead. Include the order reference, a short timeline, the relevant policy reference, and the remedy already offered. Avoid copying unnecessary personal information into an escalation. Tell the customer who owns the case and when they should expect the next update.

Knowledge quality checks

Before using this handbook in an assistant, confirm that a retrieved answer includes the filename and physical page number. Refund timing is defined on page 1, shipping replacement rules on page 2, and account recovery here on page 3. If a question is not answered by the handbook, the assistant should state that the source does not specify an answer and route the request to support.